

Fengzhi Zhu

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GitHub: [fengzhi22](https://github.com/fengzhi22) Website: fengzhi22.github.io/

Research Interests

Financial Reporting, Conservatism, Disclosure, Gender, Textual Analysis

Education

Universidad Carlos III de Madrid Madrid, Spain
Ph.D. Candidate in Accounting Sep 2019 – Aug 2023 (expected)
Supervisors: Juan Manuel García Lara, Beatriz García Osma
Temple University, Fox School of Business Philadelphia, U.S.
Visiting Ph.D. student Jan 2022 – May 2022
Supervisor: Basu Sudipta
Universidad Carlos III de Madrid Madrid, Spain
Research Master in Business and Finance Sep 2017 – Jul 2019
Universidad Carlos III de Madrid Madrid, Spain
Bachelor in Finance and Accounting Sep 2013 – Jul 2017
University of Wisconsin Madison Madison, U.S.
Undergraduate international exchange student Sep 2015 – May 2016

Working Papers

Firms' Disclosure Strategies and Users' Information Acquisition

I study how firms' disclosure strategies, i.e., smoothing and bundling, affect users' decisions to acquire information. Firms can decrease (increase) the amount of disclosures released simultaneously to the market by smoothing (bundling) disclosures. Examining the filing timestamps and download logs of non-earnings 8-Ks from 2003 to 2017, I find that smoothed 8-Ks receive more downloads than non-strategic 8-Ks. Bundled 8-Ks receive more downloads than non-strategic 8-Ks in the short-run, but overall receive fewer downloads in the long-run. The results are consistent with smoothing mitigating the negative consequences of disclosure overload. In addition, smoothed good news disclosures receive more downloads while bundled bad news disclosures receive fewer downloads than non-strategic disclosures, justifying managerial incentives to smooth and bundle disclosures. Furthermore, the market reacts more positively to smoothed and bundled disclosures that receive more downloads, indicating that users' information acquisition plays an essential role in price formation.

Narrative Conservatism

with Juan Manuel García Lara and Beatriz García Osma

We define narrative conservatism as narratives reflecting bad news in a more news-consistent, timely and complete manner than good news. Using a sample of Form 8-K filings from 2004 to 2020, we find that narrative disclosure is conservative. Narrative tone of 8-Ks is more news-consistent, and 8-Ks are filed faster and contain more forward-looking statements in response to bad news than to good news. Our evidence suggests systematic differences in market reactions to 8-Ks filed by firms with different levels of narrative conservatism.

Working in
Progress

Shareholder Voting and Disclosure in M&As

with Duy Tan Do, Beatriz García Osma and Anna Toldrà-Simats

Missing narratives: An Analysis of Biases in Sample Selection and Variable Choice in Textual Analysis Research

with Andrea Bafundi, Beatriz García Osma and Encarna Guillamón-Saorín

Conference
Presentations
(*by coauthor)

Firms' Disclosure Strategies and Users' Information Acquisition

Erasmus University Rotterdam, Dec 2022

IE Business School, Dec 2022

CUNEF, Nov 2022

EAA Talent Workshop, Nov 2022

Warwick Business School, Nov 2022

2nd Bayes/Bristol PhD Conference, Oct 2022

BAFA - SWAG Doctoral Colloquium, Sep 2022

AAA Doctoral Colloquium, Jun 2022

Narrative Conservatism

EAA Doctoral Colloquium, May 2022

FARS Midyear Meeting, Jan 2022

XVI International Accounting Research Symposium, Nov 2021

Macquarie Business School, Sep 2021*

AAA Annual Meeting, Aug 2021

CAAA Annual Conference, Jun 2021

EAA Annual Meeting, May 2021

Porto University, May 2021*

PRICIT Doctoral Workshop, Apr 2021

Stockholm School of Economics Faculty Workshop, Apr 2021*

Alliance Manchester Business School, Mar 2021*

XX GRUDIS Conference & Doctoral Colloquium, Jan 2021*

EAA-VARS, Dec 2020*

IESEG School of Management, Dec 2020*

Queen Mary University of London, Dec 2020*

Shareholder Voting and Disclosure in M&As

29th Finance Forum, Jul 2022*

EAA 44th Annual Congress, May 2022*

KU Leuven, Dec 2021*

Warwick Business School, Dec 2021*

WHU - Otto Beisheim School of Management, Dec 2021*

Bayes Business School, Dec 2021*

CUNEF Universidad, Nov 2021*

1th PhD and Young Accounting Scholars Conference, Oct 2021*

CAAA Craft Workshop, Jun 2021

HEC Paris, Mar 2021*

Missing narratives: An Analysis of Biases in Sample Selection and Variable

Audit Analytics Symposium at EAA Annual Meeting, May 2021*

Natural Language Processing in Financial Markets Worskhop, Nov 2018*

Universitat Jaume I, Nov 2018*

EAA Annual Meeting, May 2018*

Conference & Workshop Participations

2022: BAFA - SWAG Annual Conference, EAA Annual Congress (Bergen)

2021: EAA Annual Congress (Bergen), CAR Virtual Conference,

EAR Virtual Conference, UT-Austin Virtual PhD Student Symposium,

Limberg Institute Virtual Python Course

2020: UT-Austin Virtual PhD Student Symposium, Statistical Programming and Open Science Methods (Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin)

2019: International Research Symposium for Accounting Academics (Madrid)

2018: International Research Symposium for Accounting Academics (Madrid)

Service

Ad-hoc reviewer:

International Journal of Disclosure and Governance

Feb 2023-present

Spanish Journal of Finance and Accounting

Feb 2022-present

Accounting and Business Research

Jan 2022-present

FARS Midyear Conference

2021

2021 and 2020 European Accounting Review Virtual Annual Conference

Member of the Organizing Committee

2019 27th Finance Forum and AEFIN Annual Meeting

Conference volunteer

Honors & Scholarships

American Accounting Association

AAA Doctoral Colloquium Grant

2022

European Accounting Association

	2021 CAAA Annual Conference Grant	2020
	Universidad Carlos III de Madrid	
	Movilidad PPI Investigadoras/es en Formación Predoctoral	2022
	Doctoral and Master Training Scholarship	2017-2023
	Undergraduate Exchange Program Grant	2015
Academic Associations	European Accounting Association	Nov 2020 – Present
	Canadian Academic Accounting Association	Jan 2021 – Present
	American Accounting Association	Jul 2021 – Present
	Accounting and Economics Society	Jun 2022 – Present
Teaching	Universidad Carlos III de Madrid	
	13174: Financial Accounting (Undergraduate, 3.2/5)	Fall 2021
	17622: Principles of Accounting (Undergraduate, 4.3/5)	Spring 2021
	13157: Introduction to Accounting (Undergraduate, 4.0/5)	Spring 2020
	13157: Introducción a la Contabilidad (Undergraduate, 2.5/5)	Spring 2019
Work Experience	Procter & Gamble	Madrid, Spain
	Financial Data Analyst Intern	Jan 2017 – Aug 2017
Skills	Programming	
	Python, Stata, R, LaTeX, Git, Microsoft Office Suite, Linux	
	Languages	
	Mandarin (native), English (bilingual), Spanish (proficient), Cantonese (intermediate)	